



EXTERNSHIP MENTOR TRACKER

Mentee Name: Tracy Burkes

Externship Start Date: 1/7/2026

Business Name: Ross and Burkes Catering LLC

Phone: (229)-379-1985

Program: Culinary Arts and Operations

Hours needed for the program: 150

Externship End Date: 2/11/2026

Website:

Email: tracyburkes@yahoo.com

Course: CU292 - Culinary Industry Externship I

MENTORING AGREEMENT

Mentorship is a mutual commitment, both personal and professional, to growth. As an alumni mentor, my goal is to support you during your externship by offering guidance, perspective, and accountability as you work toward your business objectives. This document outlines our approach to communication and collaboration. It is meant to keep us aligned—not as a contract, but as a tool to clarify expectations and help you maximize this experience. Please review the sections carefully and keep a copy for your reference. We will revisit it as needed throughout your externship.

WHAT I EXPECT FROM MY MENTEES:

1. I expect us to communicate openly and consistently so we can build a strong, respectful mentoring relationship. That means being honest about your goals, strengths, challenges, and any personal factors that might affect how you work or what support you need.
2. I expect you to take ownership of your externship experience. This is your opportunity to apply your learning in a real business context, whether it's your own business or a partner organization. I'm here to mentor, not manage. I will support you, challenge you when needed, and share insight from my experience as a graduate and working professional. But you are responsible for showing up, following through, and driving your progress.
3. I expect you to approach this relationship with professionalism and commitment, treating it like any other part of your business growth. That includes preparing for meetings, following up on action steps, and being accountable. I'm here to help you succeed, but that only works if we both take this seriously.
4. Don't worry about impressing me, I'm not evaluating you for a grade or writing a recommendation letter (unless requested and appropriate). I'm here because I want to see you grow. I'll give you honest feedback, help you think critically about your decisions, and support your development not just as a student, but as a future business owner and leader.

WHAT MY MENTEES CAN EXPECT FROM ME

1. I commit to supporting your growth not just as a student, but as a budding professional and entrepreneur. Whether you're starting your own business or gaining experience through an externship, I'll help you think critically, set achievable goals, and reflect on your progress. I'll ask questions that challenge you to grow, not to judge, but to help you sharpen your mindset and decision-making skills.
2. I commit to showing up. I'm balancing my career, projects, and responsibilities, but I take this mentorship seriously. I limit the number of people I mentor because I want to give each relationship my attention and respect. You can expect me to listen, provide honest feedback, and meet regularly based on what we agree works best. If you need more support, please don't hesitate to ask. I'm here for you.

Preferred Day: Sunday Monday ☒ Tuesday Wednesday Thursday Friday Saturday

Meeting Frequency: ☒ Once a Week Every other week

Meeting Time: 7:00PM

Meeting Duration (in minutes): 30

Best Way to Contact: Text ☒ School Portal Phone ☒ Zoom Google Meeting

Should unforeseen circumstances/events arise resulting in changes to the meeting time/day, we will give our mentoring partner at least 30 hour(s) notice if possible.

MENTORING LOG

Date	Time	Competency Discussed	Action Plan Step	How & When Completed	Notes / Follow-up
12/30/2025	07:00	Developing Ross and Burkes Catering	Development		
		Targeting working adults and families Thomasville, GA	11am - 7 pm		
		, serving fresh, homestyle meals for lunch, dinner, and local events.			
		Food Truck			

Externship Time Sheets

Week	Week Starting	Total Hours
1.	1/7/2026	
2.		
3.		
4.		
5.		
6.		

SMART GOALS

Goal #	Specific	Measurable	Achievable	Relevant	Time-Bound
1.	Marketing				
2.					
3.					
4.					
5.					
6.					
7.					
8.					
9.					
10.					
11.					
12.					
13.					
14.					

NOTES TO SELF (CRITICAL/FLAGGED ITEMS)

	Date	Session Summary	Observations / Follow-Up
1.	1/1/2026	Catering contracts	Need samples
2.	1/7/206	300 Harris St, Thomasville, GA	Business address
3.			
4.			
5.			
6.			

SUGGESTIONS

RESEARCH

<https://eforms.com/employment/independent-contractor/catering/>
<https://www.lawdepot.com/us/business/catering-service-agreement/>
<https://riverbluffsliving.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/03/catering-contract.pdf>
<https://www.internationalcaterers.org/assets/docs/CONTRACT%203%20pages.pdf>

Mentor Summary Snapshot

Mentee Progress Risk Level: Low Medium ☒ High

Current SMART Goal Progress: ☒ On Track Needs Revision

Meeting Regularity: ☒ Consistent Infrequent

Final Verification: Portal Complete Manual Sheet Needed

Alignment Check

Are goals still relevant to the mentee's actual business activity?

Are we on track to meet the required hours?

Does the mentee seem motivated, distracted, or overwhelmed?

Do we need to revisit the frequency or format of meetings?

Mentee Action Plan

With the mentee, set goals that are focused, realistic, and aligned with their company's objectives. Practical goals should be SMART:

S: Specific: What, When, Where, Why, and Which?

M: Measurable: Metrics and Milestones. How much? What percentage? How can you measure the outcomes of this goal? In days, weeks, or years?

A: Achievable: Do you have the skills and tools to accomplish this objective? What else do you need to build? What type of experience and/or training do you need?

R: Results-oriented: Does this goal fit with your overall career and life objectives?

T: Time-based: Intermediate and final deadlines?

Focus on competencies that align with the mentee's goals. Build on both your strengths and weaknesses. Seek opportunities to learn through hands-on experience, as well as by observing and listening.

QUESTIONS FOR MENTEE

1. How can I help you achieve your goals?
2. What accomplishments are you most proud of? What helped you achieve these goals?
3. What kind of lifestyle are you looking for?
4. Why are you interested in this type of work?
5. What strengths can you bring to this type of work?
6. What has been your biggest challenge? What did you learn from it?

7. How often do you ask for feedback to learn more about yourself?
8. What are you doing now to prepare for your next steps?
9. How does this fit into your long-term career goals?
10. What inspired you to seek mentorship?

QUESTIONS FOR MENTOR

1. What skills or personal qualities do you feel contribute most to success in this industry?
2. When were you most satisfied with your career?
3. What do you wish you had known when you were starting your culinary career?
4. What are some steps I can take to start my own business?
5. Where do you draw inspiration from?
6. How do you manage a healthy work-life balance?
7. Is there anyone else you know that you think it would be good to talk to, and would you be willing to connect me with them?
8. What resources have you found to help build your business/career

MENTOR BENEFITS

Mentoring is a valuable tool for developing our most important asset, the student. A successful mentoring process relies on partners sharing common goals and expectations, committing to the mentoring relationship, and building mutual trust and respect.

Both the mentor and the mentee grow and give back through the mentoring process. As a mentor, you have the chance to reflect on your accomplishments and challenges as a reminder of the lessons you've learned. By sharing your expertise, you create a legacy and help guide someone else's career path. This also allows you to review and reenergize your personal career goals.

You, the mentor, will gain many benefits from this experience. Here are just a few additional advantages you might consider:

- Personal satisfaction in helping someone grow professionally
- Learning from the mentee
- Building new relationships
- Developing your skill as a “teacher” — helping someone clarify their career goals
- Developing your skill as a “guide” — helping someone navigate the waters of the SPH
- Developing your skill as an “advisor” — helping someone find their strengths and weaknesses

As you reflect on being a mentor, think about whom you would like as a mentee and what you would like to impart. After all, this will be a partnership.

- Do you want someone who seems to be following your exact career path?
- Do you want someone who has skills in which you have strengths?
- Do you want someone who has different or similar skills compared to you?

- Do you want someone who has an interest in skills and knowledge similar to yours, but does not possess those competencies now?
- Do you want someone who is motivated by upward mobility?

Mentor roles and responsibilities

Development of your mentee depends on exploring career aspirations, strengths, and weaknesses, collaborating on means to “get there,” implementing strategies, and evaluating along the way. You, as the mentor, provide the “light” for the mentee to follow. Sharing your wisdom and past experiences is what the mentee looks for.

Here are a few roles and responsibilities to help you in the process:

- Support the mentee’s development of professional and interpersonal competencies through strategic questioning, goal setting, and planning.
- Create a supportive and trusting environment.
- Agree to, and schedule, uninterrupted time with your mentee.
- Stay accessible, committed, and engaged during the length of the program.
- Actively listen and question.
- Give feedback to the mentee on their goals, situations, plans, and ideas.
- Encourage your mentee by giving them genuine, positive reinforcement.
- Serve as a positive role model.
- Provide frank and kind corrective feedback, if necessary.
- Openly and honestly share “lessons learned” from your own experience.
- Keep discussions on track.
- Respect your mentee’s time and resources.
- Participate in the scheduled events for the program.
- Seek assistance if questions arise that you cannot answer.

PRACTICAL QUESTIONING TIPS FOR MENTORS

As a mentor, it can be very tempting to jump in and solve your mentee’s problems for them. However, your role is to help the mentee think for themselves, and to do that, you need to ask thought-provoking questions. Help your partner self-discover. Questions should usually be open-ended, meaning they cannot be answered with just one word.

We want you to be a questioning coach. Use questions to help your mentee reflect on their experiences and learn from yours. Being a questioning coach gives you, the mentor, an opportunity to:

- Uncover additional facts and information about your mentee;
- Confirm your mentee’s goals, aspirations, and needs;
- Explore strong feelings about situations;
- Define problems and possible solutions;

- Discover your mentee's commitment to their growth.

Exploratory questions — to assess the real issues and gain a greater understanding:

- What are the most interesting aspects of your job?
- Why did you pick this to concentrate on?
- What do you want to gain?
- What do you want to be known for?
- What do you understand the issue to be?
- What tells you that your assessment is correct? What are other people's perceptions of this issue?
- What assumptions are you making here?
- What other ideas do you have?
- How long has this been an issue?
- What did you learn from past experiences that you didn't expect to learn?
- What are the reasons behind an issue?
- Have you tried to resolve this issue before? Why or why not? If yes, what was the result?
- What choices do you have?
- What progress have you made?
- What other ideas do you have?
- How are you using the things/ideas we've spoken about?
- What results are you looking for?

Empowering questions — to assist the mentee to think for themselves:

- What are the skills you want to develop?
- What strategies come to mind when looking at a situation?
- What do you see as possible solutions here?
- What outcomes are you after here? Are these outcomes reasonable given the circumstances?
- What resources are available to help you move forward?
- What key players do you need help from?
- What forces may help and/or hinder you?
- What other information do you need to arrive at a solution?
- What are the pros and cons of each solution?
- What is the first step you need to take to achieve your preferred outcome?
- What alternative strategies should you develop?
- How will you know you have mastered or successfully enhanced a competency?
- How will you apply your new skill?

Ask more questions to understand the responses you've received truly. Rephrase the answer to confirm you've heard the reply correctly.

Most importantly, ask more questions and offer fewer answers. Remember, the person who talks the most learns the most!

GIVING FEEDBACK — CHECKLIST FOR MENTORS

Think of feedback as a teaching/counseling opportunity. Exhibit positive or neutral body language.

Do use:

- Good eye contact
- Interested/neutral facial expression
- Nodding of the head to show understanding or agreement
- Calm tone of voice
- Even voice volume
- Sitting slightly forward
- Relaxed arm and hand placement

Do not use:

- Reduced eye contact, scowling, or narrowing of eyes
- Tense or aggressive posture
- Rocking, pen bouncing, hand wringing, or your specific version of nervousness/defensiveness
- Hands on hips or tightly clenched
- Arms tightly crossed across chest
- A blank expression

Use “I” statements. Give examples from your experience. Don't say, “but” or “however.”

Avoid statements that describe someone instead of their actions. Ensure feedback is specific.

Give the other person an opportunity to ask questions or share their viewpoint.

Listen carefully not only to the words but also to the feelings and body language of the speaker. Don't become defensive.

Don't interrupt when the other person is responding.

Allow time and privacy for feedback — avoid/minimize distractions, set aside an uninterrupted time for your feedback session.

HELP YOUR MENTEE PLAN FOR NEXT STEPS. ASK QUESTIONS SUCH AS:

- What is a step you can take to reach your desired outcome?
- What are some ways you can think of to resolve this challenge?
- What resources are available to you?

- What can I do to help you?

TIPS FOR BEING A GOOD LISTENER

Be an “active” listener. That means doing the following:

- Give the person your undivided attention.
 - Stay off your phone and computer, and avoid disruptions.
 - Hear the person out. Avoid interrupting.
 - Be aware of your non-verbal cues such as nodding, smiling, and maintaining eye contact.
 - To ensure that you heard the person correctly:
 - ✓ Rephrase
 - ✓ “As I understand ...”
 - ✓ “So, you’re saying that ...”
 - ✓ “Let me see if I got that ...”
 - ✓ “So, your three concerns are ...”
 - ✓ “There seem to be a few issues ...”
 - ✓ “So, our main goals this time are ...”
 - ✓ Summarize
-

INITIATING A CONVERSATION:

Dear Mr. Jones,

My name is Joan Smith, and I am a student in the _____ program. Thank you for volunteering your time to provide guidance and support to Escoffier students. I am interested in pursuing a career after I graduate from Escoffier. I see from your profile that you _____.

Would you be willing to meet with me for 20 minutes within the next two weeks to discuss (Project/Goals/Questions)? I would appreciate the opportunity to meet with you to get feedback and any advice on how I can advance my career.

Thank you for your time!

Warm regards